

SUSHANT BANJARA
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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago PhD, Public Policy	2021 - 2027
Yale University Masters, Environmental Science	2017 - 2019
Tribhuvan University, Institute of Engineering Bachelors, Civil Engineering	2011 - 2016

REFERENCES

Eyal Frank (Chair) Assistant Professor Harris School of Public Policy University of Chicago eyalfrank@uchicago.edu	Oeindrila Dube Philip K. Pearson Professor Harris School of Public Policy University of Chicago odube@uchicago.edu
James Robinson University Professor Harris School of Public Policy University of Chicago jamesrobinson@uchicago.edu	Shaoda Wang Associate Professor Harris School of Public Policy University of Chicago shaoda@uchicago.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Human Cost of Conservation: Evidence from Protected Areas in Africa

WORKING PAPERS

- Environmental Degradation in One's Own Backyard: Who Wins and Who Loses From Sand Mining in India** (with Claire Fan, Varun K, and Katie Zhang)
- The Economic Costs of Climate Change From Ecosystem Disruptions: Evidence From Forest Defoliation Outbreaks in the United States** (with Greg Dwyer, Eyal Frank, and Andrew M. Liebhold)
- On Strategic Civilian Targeting in Civil War** (with Gina Eckhoff)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- The Politics Machine: Data Centers and Grassroots Political Actions in the US** (with Prabidhik KC)
- When Do Incentives for Preemptive Action Erode Gains from Policy? Studying the Effectiveness of the Endangered Species Act** (with Eyal Frank and Anouch Missirian)
- The Political Economy of Protected Areas Designation**

PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

- Paudel, S. R., **Banjara, S. P.**, Choi, O. K., Park, K. Y., Kim, Y. M., & Lee, J. W. (2017). Pretreatment of agricultural biomass for anaerobic digestion: Current state and challenges. *Bioresource technology*, 245, 1194-1205
- Paudel, S. R., **Banjara, S. P.**, Wagle, A., & Freund, F. T. (2018). Earthquake chemical precursors in groundwater: a review. *Journal of Seismology*, 1-22

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Innovations for Poverty Action 2025, **\$82,868** (with Corey Vernot and Arjun Kharel) – “Increasing Legal Access for Migrant Victims of Fraud: Evidence from Nepal”

The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, 2025 **\$49,000** (with Claire Fan and Varun K) – “The Environmental and Human Costs of Sand Mining”

EPIC India Research Fund 2023, **\$10,000** (with Claire Fan and Varun K) – “The Environmental and Human Costs of Sand Mining”

The Pearson Institute Grant, **\$10,000** (with Claire Fan and Varun K) – “The Environmental and Human Costs of Sand Mining”

Development Economics Research Fund 2023, **\$5,000** – “Political Economy of Construction Minerals Extraction: Evidence from Nepal”

Griffin Incubator 2021 – The Data Revolution, **\$40,000** (with Eyal Frank and Anouch Missirian) – “Land-Use Restrictions and Perverse Incentives: Using Machine Learning to Evaluate the Endangered Species Act from High-Frequency Satellite Data”

International House Non-Resident Graduate Fellowship 2022 - 2025, **\$3,000 per year**

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago (Master’s level courses)

Coding Camp, Instructor	2026
Methods of Data Collection: Experiments and Surveys (PPHA 44900 1), Head TA	2026
Math Camp, Instructor	2024 - 2025
Statistics for Data Analysis I (PPHA 31002), Head TA	2022 - 2024
Data and Programming for Public Policy I - R (PPHA 30535), Head TA	2023

Yale University (Undergraduate level courses)

Intro to Computing for Scientists and Engineers in C++ (ENAS 130)	2018
Ordinary and Partial Differential Equation (ENAS 194)	2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago

Part time research assistant for Professor Anne Karing	2022
Part time research assistant for Professor Eduardo Montero	2022

Energy Policy Institute at The University of Chicago

Predoctoral Fellow for Professor Eyal Frank	2019 - 2021
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CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop	2026
Midwest International Economic Development Conference, UIUC	2025
Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development, Columbia University	2025
LSE Environment Camp, London School of Economics	2025

SERVICE

Reviewer for Midwest International Economic Development Conference	2023
Co-organiser for Energy and Environment Economics Weekly Student Seminar	2023
Panel Moderator for South Asia Forum - Natural Disasters Risk Management Spring	2023

Predoctoral fellow recruitment for Energy Policy Institute at The University of Chicago
Board Member for South Asian Graduate Students Association at Yale

2020
2017 – 2019

SKILLS

Technical

R, R-spatial, Python, Stata, Google Earth Engine, Remote Sensing, Machine Learning

Languages

Nepali (Native), English, Hindi, Maithili